PO Guide Part I · Short Notes ✍️

Part I: Organisation of DOP · 23 Circles · History · Clauses 1 to 20

For GDS → MTS · Postman · Mail Guard exams

Yellow = must remember IMP = asked often 📝 PYQ · State-Year = came in a past paper

Red = asked the tricky way

Parts of the PO Guide

PO Guide = 4 parts

- → **I** Rules for inland post
- → **II** Rules for foreign post
- → **III** List of post offices
- → **IV** Savings bank + PO savings schemes

Part I = 7 sections

I General · II Letter & Parcel · III Official · **IV Prohibited** 📝 PYQ · Haryana 2020 · V Money Order · VI Philately · VII PLI

💡 **Remember**

The 7 sections in order: **"G-L-O-P, M-P-P"** = General, Letter, Official, Prohibited, MO, Philately, PLI

Organisation of the Department of Posts (DOP)

- ★ Started by **Lord Dalhousie** · present form from **1 October 1854**
- → IMP DOP comes under the **Ministry of Communications** · in charge = Communications Minister 📝 PYQ · Bihar 2021
- → Administrative control → **DG Post, New Delhi** (all administration + operations)
- → Head of DOP → **Secretary, Department of Posts**
- → Headquarters → **Dak Bhawan, New Delhi**
- → PLI **Directorate** → New Delhi · PLI **Director** → Kolkata
- → IMP Whole country = **23 postal circles** 📝 PYQ · Chhattisgarh 2021 · Delhi 2022 · Telangana 2020
- → A separate wing for the armed forces, the **Army Postal Service (APS)** = **Base Circle**
- → Office of the Controller of Foreign Mails → **Mumbai**

Army Postal Service (APS)

- → Total APOs = 2
- → **56 APO** = New Delhi = **1 CBPO** · PIN **900056**
- → Head: **ADG, APS** · rank = **Major General**
- → Officers come on **deputation** from the civil post

- → 99 APO = Kolkata = 2 CBPO · PIN 900099
- → Headquarters: New Delhi (Sena Dak Bhawan) PYQ · Telangana 2020
- → Other ranks: 75% from DOP + 25% recruited by the Army
- → 2 CBPOs + APS Training Centre Kamptee, Nagpur → Commandants, rank Colonel

Postal Services Board (PSB)

- → The apex management body of DOP = PSB = Chairperson + 6 Members
- → Permanent invitees: DG Postal Services · ADG (Coordination) · AS&FA
- → AS&FA heads the Integrated Finance Wing (IFW) · Secretary to the Board = a senior staff officer of the Directorate

6 Members	Handle
Planning & HRD	HR development, philately, estates, planning
Personnel	Personnel management
PLI	PLI + investment of PLI funds
Banking & DBT	Banking + Direct Benefit Transfer
Operations	Postal operations
Technology	Technology induction + implementation

Top to bottom: who heads what

Unit	Head
Circle	CPMG (Chief Postmaster General)
Region	PMG
Division	SSP / SP PYQ · Delhi 2022 · Maharashtra 2022 · Tamil Nadu 2020
Sub-division	IP / ASP
RMS Division	SRM / SSRM PYQ · Uttarakhand 2020

Circle → Region → Division → Sub-division · Depot (store + stamp depots merged) → Superintendent

At the very top: Minister of Communications → Minister of State → Secretary (Posts) / PSB Chairperson + DG Postal Services

★ At a glance: Organisation

4	7	23	2	6
PO Guide parts	Part I sections	postal circles	APOs	PSB members

75%
APS staff from DOP

> ⚠️ **Exam trap**
> PLI **Directorate is in Delhi**, but the PLI **Director is in Kolkata**.

> 💡 **Remember**
> **56 = Delhi** (1 CBPO) · **99 = Kolkata** (2 CBPO) · PIN = 900 + APO number

The 23 postal circles

Circles with more than one state / UT (asked the most):

Circle	Includes	Trick
North East (HQ **Shillong**)	Manipur, Meghalaya, Mizoram, Arunachal, Tripura, Nagaland = **6** 📝 PYQ · Haryana 2022	MMM + ATN
West Bengal	West Bengal, Andaman & Nicobar, Sikkim	WAS
Maharashtra	Maharashtra, Goa 📝 PYQ · Maharashtra 2022	GM
Gujarat	Gujarat, Dadra Nagar Haveli, Daman & Diu	DDG
Kerala	Kerala, Lakshadweep, **Mahe**	KLM
Punjab	Punjab, Chandigarh	PC
Tamil Nadu	Tamil Nadu, Pondicherry	TP
Andhra Pradesh	Andhra Pradesh, **Yanam**	AY
J&K	Jammu & Kashmir, Ladakh	JL

Headquarters (the red ones differ from the circle name and are asked the tricky way):

Andhra → **Vijayawada** · Assam → Guwahati · Bihar → Patna · Chhattisgarh → Raipur · Delhi → New Delhi · Gujarat → Ahmedabad · Haryana → **Ambala Cantt** · Himachal → Shimla · J&K → Srinagar · Jharkhand → Ranchi · Karnataka → Bengaluru · Kerala → Thiruvananthapuram · MP → Bhopal · Maharashtra → Mumbai · North East → **Shillong** · Odisha → Bhubaneswar · Punjab → **Chandigarh** · Rajasthan → Jaipur · Tamil Nadu → Chennai · Telangana → Hyderabad · UP → Lucknow · Uttarakhand → Dehradun · West Bengal → Kolkata

★ At a glance: Circles

23	6	+1
circles	states in North East	Base Circle (APS)

⚠ Exam trap

Mahe belongs to Puducherry but is in the **Kerala** circle · **Yanam** belongs to Puducherry but is in the **Andhra** circle.

💡 Remember

Haryana's HQ is **not** Chandigarh, it is **Ambala Cantt**. Chandigarh = Punjab circle.

Directorates, institutions, training

Directorate	Where	Deals with
Parcel	Malcha Marg, New Delhi	Parcels, e-commerce, international parcels, EMS
PLI	Chanakyapuri, New Delhi	PLI + RPLI, insurance investment
BD	Dak Bhawan, New Delhi	Retail, business, direct post, POPSK, Aadhaar
APS	Sena Dak Bhawan, New Delhi	Mail of army, paramilitary, navy, air force

Heads of institutions

- Circle → CPMG · Region → PMG · APS → ADG
- GPO → Director / Chief PM / Sr. PM
- CEPT Mysore → **General Manager**
- BD, PLI, Parcel → **CGM** · PTC, RAKNPA → Director
- RLO → Manager · PSD → Superintendent

Training

- **RAKNPA** → **Ghaziabad (UP)** · head: Director · trains Group A, Group B, foreign postal managers
- **CEPT** → **Mysore**
- **PTC = 6**: Saharanpur, Vadodara, Mysore, Madurai, Darbhanga, Guwahati
- **RTC = 4**: Bhubaneswar, Delhi, Nashik, Hubballi

💡 Remember

PTC 6 = "**Saha-Vad-My-Madu-Dar-Gu**" · RTC 4 = "**Bhu-Del-Na-Hu**"

⚠ Exam trap

CEPT is headed by a **General Manager**, but RAKNPA by a **Director**.

History of the post

Year	What happened
1727	First post office in **Kolkata**
1774 · 1786 · 1793	GPOs: Kolkata · Chennai · Mumbai
1837	First Post Office Act (for uniformity)
1852	Asia's first adhesive stamp, in Sindh = **Scinde Dawk** (used till June 1866)
1854	New Act (base of the modern post) · **1 Oct** first all-India stamp · **Railway Mail Service** · sea mail to Britain + China
1898	Indian Post Office Act 1898
18 Feb 1911	World's first airmail: **Allahabad → Naini** (about 18 km)
24 Dec 2023	**Post Office Act 2023** notified

💡 **Remember**

"**1854 = three things**": new Act + first all-India stamp + Railway Mail Service

⚠️ **Exam trap**

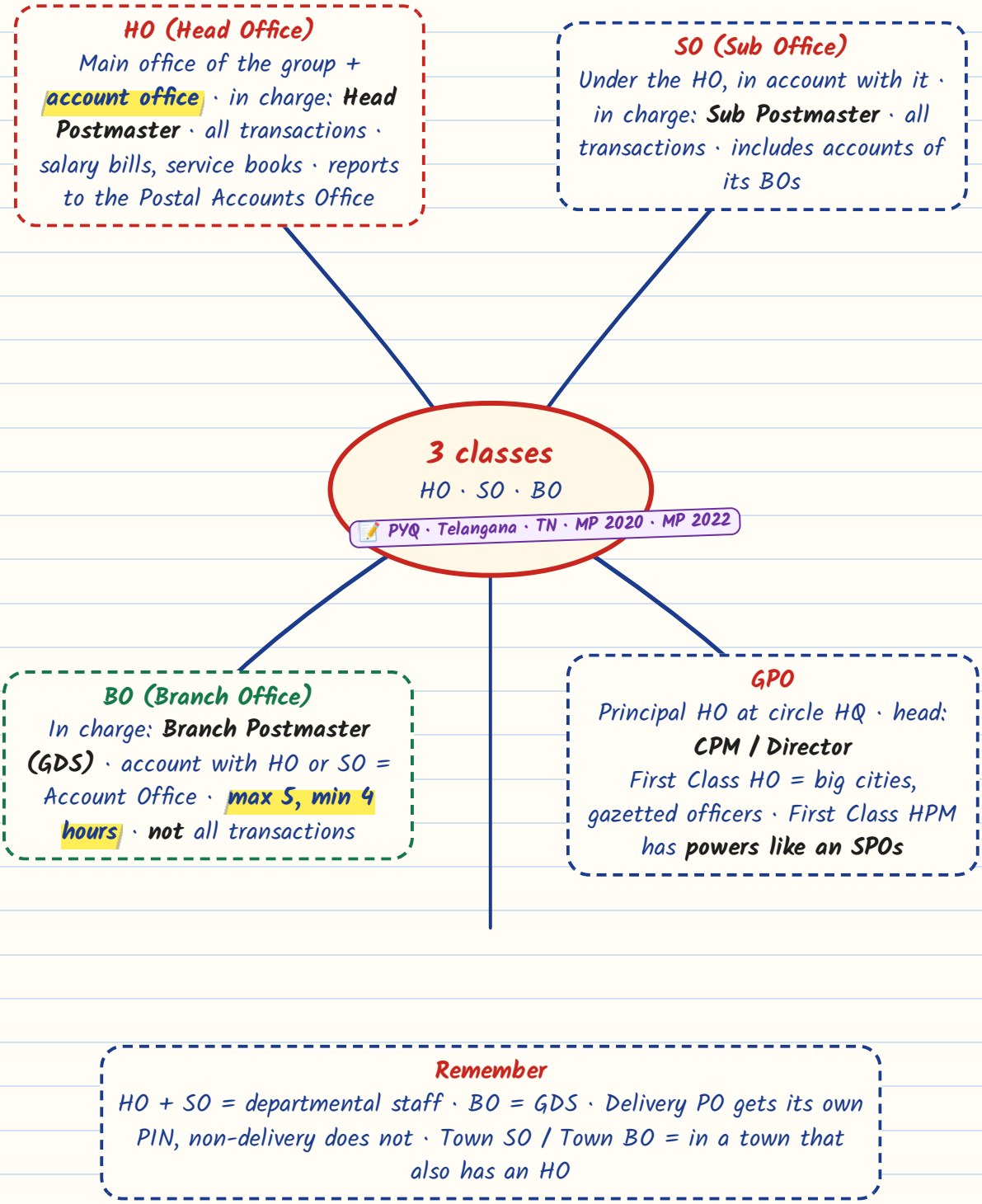
Asia's first stamp was **1852, Sindh**, but the first all-India stamp was **1854**.

✍️ **Test yourself**

1. Which ministry is the DOP under?
2. HQ of the Haryana circle?
3. Which circle is Mahe in?
4. Where is 99 APO?
5. The world's first airmail flew from where to where?

Answers: 1 Communications · 2 Ambala Cantt · 3 Kerala · 4 Kolkata (2 CBPO) · 5 Allahabad → Naini

Classes of post offices · Mind map



Remember

HO + SO = departmental staff · BO = GDS · Delivery PO gets its own PIN, non-delivery does not · Town SO / Town BO = in a town that also has an HO

Classes of post offices

Heads of HOs

Director-headed GPO	Director
Other GPOs	Chief PM / Sr. PM
Non-gazetted HO	Postmaster
1st class gazetted HO	Chief Postmaster
2nd class gazetted HO	Sr. Postmaster

Types of SO (by number of staff)

- → **Time Scale**: MDG, HSG, LSG
- → **Selection Grade**: Triple (A), Double (B), Single handed (C)

7 jobs of a BO

- → Delivery, dispatch, booking, accepting parcels
- → SB deposit + SB withdrawal
- → Issue + payment of money orders

★ At a glance: Clause 2

3	5	4	7
classes	BO max hours	BO min hours	BO jobs

⚠ Exam trap

HO and SO do **all** transactions (they differ only in a few SB jobs). A BO can **not** do all.

💡 Remember

HO = **H**ead, SO = **S**ub, BO = **B**ranch (village, GDS)

Night Post Office

- → IMP Normal working hours fixed by → **Head of Circle (CPMG)**
  - 📝 PYQ · Maharashtra 2020 · Bihar 2021
- → **DG** can extend any PO's hours up to **8:30 PM** + keep it open on Sunday = Night PO
  - 📝 PYQ · Chhattisgarh 2021
- → A Night PO does only the work authorised by the DG
- ✓ In extended hours: registered booking (VP included) · IPO + stamp sale · SB deposit + cash certificates (till **7 PM**)
- ✓ Sunday / holiday: **10 AM to 5 PM**
- ✗ Stopped on Sunday / holiday: delivery · SB + PO certificates · MO payment

💡 Remember

DG = "**D**oor **o**pen at ni**G**ht" · DG stretches the time

⚠ Exam trap

DG extends hours, **CPMG fixes** normal hours. On Sunday it is **10–5**, not 8:30.

Mobile Post Office

- → A specially designed **van** going to fixed points → **late-posting** facility in cities
- ✓ Stamps + stationery · insured parcels · surface + air registered letter mail · air parcels · unregistered mail · e-MO · My Stamp · postal banking
- ✗ **No VP booking** · **closed** on Sundays and postal holidays
- → MO booking allowed only at mobile POs of **Madras and Nagpur**

> 💡 **Remember**
> Mobile: **no VP** · MO only in **Ma-Na** (Madras, Nagpur)

> ⚠️ **Exam trap**
> The mobile PO is also **closed on Sunday**. Only the Night PO is open on Sunday.

Business hours

- → Hours clearly notified at every PO + RMS office · counter work stops **exactly** at the fixed time
- → Fixed with regard to: **local convenience + arrival / departure of mail**

📝 PYQ · Haryana 2022

Work	Week days	Saturday
Enquiry, stamps & stationery sale, certificate of posting 📝 PYQ · Assam 2020	**Entire hours**	Entire hours
Registered, insured, VP, parcel booking	**6–7 hrs**	**5 hrs**, till 3 PM
MO, postal orders, SB, certificates, phone bills 📝 PYQ · Delhi 2022	**about 5 hrs**	**3 hrs**, till 1 PM

- → IMP **POs in charge of GDS: max 5 hours**

📝 PYQ · Chhattisgarh 2021 · Kerala 2021 · MP 2020 · TN 2020

- → Window delivery of registered / insured / VP + MO payment → during the booking hours of that class
- → Most stationary RMS offices: registered booking + stamp & stationery sale

★ At a glance: Clauses 3–5

8:30	10–5	7 PM	5 hrs	6–7
Night PO till	Night PO Sunday	SB deposit till	GDS PO max	registered booking hrs

⚠ Exam trap

VP articles and MOs can **not** be booked to an Army Post Office address.

📝 PYQ · Maharashtra 2020 · Haryana 2020

💡 Remember

Saturday: registered till **3 PM**, money work till **1 PM** (money closes first)

Sundays and postal holidays

- → All POs except Night POs are **closed** (mobile too) → no public business + street letter boxes not cleared
- ✓ Late letters can go in: RMS letter boxes · selected offices · mail van letter boxes of RMS
- ✗ Machine-franked articles must **not** go in: PO letter boxes · mail van letter boxes
- → Registered newspapers **without late fee** at: press sorting offices · RMS offices · Night POs
- → RMS offices (fixed hours): stamps, stationery, certificate of posting + registered on late fee

Post office holidays

Total **17** = **14 compulsory** + **3** varying by circle

3 National

Republic Day · Independence Day · Gandhi Jayanti

11 Religious

Budh Purnima, Dussehra, Guru Nanak Jayanti, Mahaveer Jayanti, Eid ul Fitr, Muharram, Diwali, Christmas, Good Friday, Bakrid, Eid-e-Milad

★ At a glance: Clauses 7–8

₹3	₹2	17	14	3
late fee registered	late fee unregistered	total holidays	compulsory	by circle

💡 Remember

17 = 14 + 3 · 14 = 3 national + 11 religious

⚠️ Exam trap

Registered **newspapers** pay **no late fee** on Sunday, but registered **articles** pay ₹3.

Why prepay postage

- → Fully prepaid articles → go by the **earliest mail** + are delivered fast
- ✗ Unpaid / underpaid: **no extra security** · may be **detained** to tax the postage due · **not** issued with special deliveries

💡 Remember

Full stamp = full speed 🚀

Postage stamps and stationery

- → Postage is normally paid with **postage stamps** · issued by **India Post** under the **authority of the Government of India**
- → Stationery (envelopes, inland letter cards, postcards) has the stamp embossed · if more postage is needed, add **extra stamps**
- → Postage can also be paid by **franking machine** impressions
- → Overseas philately orders → **Indian Philatelic Bureau, Bombay GPO**

⚠️ Exam trap

Revenue stamp: the PO only **sells** it, the **Central Government** issues it, and it can **not** be used for postage. 📝 PYQ · MP 2020

✍️ Test yourself

1. Night PO timing on Sunday?
2. Which article can't be booked at a mobile PO?
3. Max hours of a PO in charge of GDS?
4. Total postal holidays?
5. Late fee for an unregistered article?

Answers: 1 10 AM to 5 PM · 2 VP · 3 5 hours · 4 17 · 5 ₹2

Franking machine · Mind map



Key points

- Machine number **X123456**: X = maker (**F** Francotyp Postalia, **N** Neopost, **P** Pitney Bowes) + 6 digits
- Funds kept safe in the **PSD (Postal Security Device)** · maker's server dials the DOP server **3 times a day**
- New licence **14 working days** · renewal **5 working days** (start 1 month before expiry) · rejected → fee back in 30 working days
- Bring: **window delivery ticket** (identification) + 2 copies of the SOM · **3% commission** on value of franks
- Govt departments: advance ₹2000 to ₹9900 · receipt **ACG-67** · 2 offices incl. 1 HO (LSG or above) · word "Service" in the licence die · registers kept 2 years

★ At a glance: Franking

5 yrs	₹375	2	3%	30 days
licence valid	fee	max POs	rebate / commission	server dial

⚠ Exam trap

Older rule: impression **red**, but **RMFM impression is blue**. If the question says "RMFM / Digi Frank", answer blue.

💡 Remember

Franked mail **not in letter boxes** · if posted there = **Unpaid**

Prepayment of postage in cash

- For firms posting very large numbers of unregistered packets → certain POs authorised by the **Head of Circle**
- Minimum: **500 in big cities** · **250 in small towns** at a time
- Some POs in Bombay, Kolkata, Madras, Nagpur, Delhi → registration fee also in cash (with special registered journals)
- Selected gazetted / HSG POs → firms posting at least **500 articles**
- ✓ Available for: letters, ILCs, postcards, packets, unregistered articles, registered newspapers 📝 PYQ · Chhattisgarh 2022 · **not** for others
- Special registration envelopes (from the PO) → **registered articles only**

Spoilt and fictitious stamps

- **Not valid** for postage: cut, torn, defaced, obliterated, over-printed, imperfect stamps, or stamps cut from embossed envelopes
- Re-using a used stamp to cause loss to the government = **offence under the IPC**
- IMP Making / using fictitious stamps = punishable under **Section 263-A, IPC 1860**
  PYQ · Tamil Nadu 2020
- Reproduction allowed for illustration in philatelic publications, only in **black**

> 💡 **Remember**
> **263-A** = fictitious stamps · philatelic reproduction = **black**

> ⚠️ **Exam trap**
> 500 packets in **big cities**, 250 in **small towns**. Don't swap them.

Packing and sealing

- IMP Every letter / packet / parcel gets date stamps of at least **2 POs**: **booking + destination**
  PYQ · Rajasthan · Jharkhand · Andhra 2021 · Bihar · MP · Delhi 2022
- Strong cover: pressure + friction in mail bags + stamping pressure
- The PO takes **no special precaution** for fragile articles
- Wax cloth → **inside** cover, strong paper outside (for date stamps and stamps) · no sharp edges
- **Avoid sealing wax** outside unregistered articles · if used, lay **thin tissue paper** over it · especially for foreign mail through hot climates

Coins and valuables

Coins, bullion, precious stones, jewellery, gold / silver articles, currency notes → inland **only insured**
PYQ · Gujarat 2020

- "Gold or silver articles" include partly made of them (not coins)
- "Coins" exclude cut counterfeit coins sent by the currency department · "notes" exclude cancelled cut notes
- "Jewellery" includes **watches** with gold / silver cases

Letter boxes

- Letters, postcards, ILCs, packets → letter boxes at POs, public places, mobile POs, steamers
- ✗ IMP Machine-franked articles **not** in letter boxes
  PYQ · Bihar 2021 · 2022 · Delhi 2022

- "Letters only" boxes → only letters · other articles in air mail / QMS boxes are **detained**
- QMS articles need the **full PIN** below the town name
- Large letters that don't fit → at the window · bulk letters too, if postage + late fee are paid

★ At a glance: Clauses 12–20

500	250	263-A	2 POs
packets big cities	packets small towns	fictitious stamp IPC	date stamps

⚠ Exam trap

Valuables go **insured**, not just registered.

💡 Remember

2 stamps = **booking + destination** ("where it left, where it reached")

✍ Test yourself

1. Franking licence fee and validity?
2. A franked article posted in a letter box is treated as?
3. Fictitious stamps are an offence under which section?
4. Date stamps of how many POs on every article?
5. How are coins sent inland?

Answers: 1 ₹375, 5 years · 2 Unpaid · 3 IPC 263-A · 4 2 (booking + destination) · 5 Insured only

Source: PO Guide Part I · MTS / Postman notes, pages 1–27, condensed